Registration fees

Registration fee for each participating team is **₹200**.

Introduction

The competition provides a platform for students to showcase critical thinking, research, logical reasoning, public speaking, rebuttal, and teamwork.

- **Affirmative Team:** Argues in favour of the motion.
- **Negative Team:** Argues against the motion.

Participants must maintain academic integrity, professionalism, and respect throughout the competition.

Objectives of the Competition

The competition aims to:

- Develop public speaking and communication skills
- Encourage critical and analytical thinking
- Promote evidence-based argumentation
- Build research, presentation, and rebuttal skills
- Encourage teamwork and strategic thinking
- Foster respectful disagreement and democratic dialogue
- Provide experience in formal competitive debate

Team Size

- **2 speakers** per team
- 1 optional **reserve speaker**
- Only registered speakers may participate

Team Roles

- **Affirmative Team:** Supports and establishes the motion.
- **Negative Team:** Opposes and challenges the motion.

Debate Motion

"Skills matter more than traditional degrees for Viksit Bharat 2047."

1. Understanding the Motion

Affirmative Team Must:

- Interpret and define the motion clearly.
- Present arguments supporting the motion.
- Provide relevant evidence and examples.

Negative Team Must:

- Address and clarify the motion where necessary.
- Challenge the Affirmative's arguments.
- Present logical arguments against the motion.
- Support points with evidence, examples, and counterarguments.

1. Definition of the Motion

- Must be reasonable and relevant to the motion.
- Must not distort or avoid the subject.
- Must provide a fair basis for debate.
- Deliberately unreasonable **"squirrel" definitions** may be penalized.

Debate Format and Speaker Order

The exact number of speakers and duration will be announced by the Organising Committee.

Speaker	Team	Role	Time
Speaker 1– Round 1	Affirmative	Define motion & present arguments	4 Min
Speaker 1- Round 1	Negative	Challenge defination & present argument	4 Min
Speaker 1- Round 2	Affirmative	Develop argument & Rebuttal	2 Min
Speaker 1- Round 2	Negative	Develop argument & Rebuttal	2 Min

Note: The organizing committee may modify the speaking time depending on the number of participating teams and the competition schedule

Speaking Time

1. Time Signals

Bell/Signal System

- **1 Bell**: 1 minute remaining.
- **2 Bells**: Speaking time has ended.

2. Time Discipline

- Speakers must finish within the allotted time.
- Exceeding the time limit may result in a penalty.
- Speakers must conclude immediately after the final signal.
- The timekeeper's record is official.

The clock starts when the speaker begins the substantive part of the speech.

Content and Argumentation

Arguments must be:

- Relevant and logical
- Supported by credible evidence
- Clearly structured
- Appropriate for a college-level academic debate.

Arguments should ideally include:

- **Claim → Reasoning → Evidence/Example → Link to Motion**

Distinguish between:

- Facts and opinions
- Evidence and assumptions
- Correlation and causation
- Examples and generalizations

Evidence and Sources

Participants may use:

- Books & academic publications
- Government reports & official statistics
- Reputable news sources
- Peer-reviewed research
- Credible institutional & verified digital sources

1. Evidence Integrity

Participants must not:

- Fabricate statistics or quotations
- Misrepresent research or manipulate data
- Misattribute statements
- Present false information as fact

Misleading or fabricated evidence may result in score deductions or disqualification.

2. Source Acknowledgement

Where appropriate, speakers should identify the source of important statistics, quotations, research findings, or factual claims.

Rebuttal Rules

Speakers should directly address opposing arguments by:

- Identifying weaknesses and assumptions
- Challenging evidence and its relevance
- Presenting counterevidence
- Highlighting contradictions
- Explaining why the argument does not support its conclusion

No New Major Arguments in Final Rebuttal

- Refute opposing arguments
- Compare both sides
- Summarise the team's case
- New substantial arguments in the final rebuttal may be penalized.

Points of Information (POI)

If the organizing committee adopts a POI format, the following rules shall apply:

- POIs may only be offered during the designated period of a speaker's speech.
- The speaker may accept or decline a POI.
- A POI should be brief and relevant.
- The person offering a POI must remain respectful.
- Repeated interruption after a POI has been declined is prohibited.
- The speaker must retain control of the main speech.

If POIs are not part of the announced format, speakers must not interrupt an opponent's speech.

Conduct and Code of Ethics

Participants must:

- Maintain professional and respectful conduct.
- Respect opposing speakers and their arguments.
- Use appropriate language and listen attentively.
- Follow the Moderator/Chairperson’s instructions.
- Accept adjudication respectfully.
- Maintain academic integrity.

Participants must not:

- Insult, ridicule, threaten, or intimidate others.
- Use abusive, offensive, or discriminatory language/gestures.
- Interrupt, heckle, or deliberately disrupt speakers.
- Engage in plagiarism or deliberate misinformation.

Serious misconduct may result in immediate disqualification.

Use of Technology and Materials

Use of Resources:

- The organizing committee will specify whether notes, cue cards, laptops/tablets, phones, or internet resources are permitted.
- Electronic devices, if allowed, must be used only for legitimate competition purposes.
- Unauthorized external communication during the debate may be treated as a rule violation.

Judging Criteria

The debate shall be evaluated under three principal categories:

A. Matter – Content & Argumentation

- Relevant and logical arguments.
- Depth of analysis and supporting evidence.
- Understanding of the motion.
- Strong rebuttals and responses to opponents.

B. Manner – Presentation & Communication

- Clear and confident speech.
- Effective voice, pace, and language.
- Good eye contact and body language.
- Audience engagement and professionalism.

C. Method – Structure & Strategy

- Well-organized speech with clear opening and conclusion.
- Logical sequencing and strategic rebuttals.
- Team coordination and time management.
- Adherence to rules and overall coherence.

Suggested Scoring Rubric

The recommended scoring system is 100 marks per team.

Categories	Maximum Marks
Matter - Content, Logic & Evidence	40
Manner - Delivery & Communication	30
Method - Structure, Strategy & Teamwork	30

Detailed Rubric

Criterion	Marks
Understanding and interpretation of motion	10
Quality of arguments and reasoning	15
Evidence, examples and factual support	10
Rebuttal and responsiveness	5
Clarity and confidence of delivery	10
Voice, language and articulation	10
Body language and audience engagement	10
Organisation and structure	10
Team coordination	10
Time management and rule compliance	10

Penalties

Violation	Possible Penalty
Exceeding allotted speaking time	1-5 marks
Irrelevant or substantially off-topic content	1-5 marks
Deliberate interruption/heckling	1-5 marks
Repeated procedural violations	1-5 marks
Unsupported/fabricated factual claim	2-10 marks
Offensive or discriminatory language	5-20 marks or disqualification
Plagiarism/fabricated evidence	2-10 marks
Serious misconduct	Disqualification

The final penalty will be decided by the adjudication panel based on the severity and frequency of the violation.

Declaration of Winner

The winning team shall be the team receiving the highest aggregate score from adjudication panel.

- **Best Team:** Highest aggregate score from the adjudication panel.
- **Best Speaker:** Awarded to the top-performing individual speaker.

Appeals and Grievances

Participants may raise procedural concerns with the organising committee after the debate fas concluded .

However:

- Judges must not be interrupted during adjudication.
- Participants may not challenge a judge during a speech.
- Appeals must be respectful and supported by a specific procedural concern.
- The organising committee/adjudication panel shall review the matter where appropriate.
- The decision of the authorized adjudication authority shall be final.

General Rules for Participants

- Report to the venue on time with valid ID/registration details.
- Late arrival may lead to disqualification at the organisers' discretion.
- Finalised speaking order cannot be changed without permission.
- Participants must remain present throughout the competition unless permitted.
- Offensive, threatening, or discriminatory language is prohibited.
- Bring all permitted preparation materials.
- Attempts to influence judges are strictly prohibited.
- Follow all venue and institutional rules.
- Organisers may modify the schedule or format when necessary.

Recommended Debate Room Arrangement

Front/Stage

Position	Arrangement
Centre	Chairperson/Moderator
Left	Affirmative Team
Right	Negative Team
Side/Rear	Jury including timekeeper

Final Code of Debate

- Argue strongly, Listen carefully, Challenge ideas, not individuals, Use evidence responsibly, Respect disagreement.
- The Purpose of the competition is to identify the team demonstrating the best combination of knowledge, reasoning, evidence, communication, rebuttal, teamwork, and ethical conduct.
- All participants, judges, volunteers, and organisers must maintain fairness and mutual respect throughout the event.

Event Coordinator:
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